

TRIDUUM OF MASSES FOR BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER

As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate the joyous occasion of the Installation of Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry on Sunday 20 September, a Triduum of Masses will be celebrated in parishes throughout the diocese, on Friday 18, Saturday 19 and Sunday 20 September.

In our parishes of Steelstown and Culmore, these Masses will be celebrated in Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown at 10am on Friday 18th, 10am on Saturday 19th and 9am on Sunday 20th.

All are welcome to attend as we come together as God's people to pray for Bishop Router and the people of the diocese, that we may walk together in faith and hope, guided by the Holy Spirit.

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend!

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting on Wed 30 Sept, 8pm, in The Drummond Hotel, 2 Main St., Ballykelly. Registration and light refreshments from 7.30pm.

NORTHLANDS ANNUAL COFFEE MORNING Saturday 19 September in Shantallow Community Centre, BT48 8EN. Drop in anytime between 10am and 1pm for some tea & coffee, cakes (gluten free available), community and conversations. This is a great way to celebrate recovery, positive change and community. This is a family friendly event, and everyone is welcome.

QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7pm. Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. All welcome. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER

For the care of water Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.
Pray with the Pope : <https://www.popesprayer.va/praywiththepope/>

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



OFFICE: Wednesdays to Fridays: 9am to 3pm
Tel: 028 7135 1718
Email: steelstown@derrydiocese.org
culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST: Rev. Declan McGeehan
Email: declan.mcgeeahan@derrydiocese.org
Emergency Tel.: 073 5238 7817 (*urgent sick calls only*)

MASS TIMES:
Sunday: 09:00am; 11:00am and 12:15pm
Monday: 07:45am; 7:00pm
Tuesday - Friday: 07:45am and 10:00am
Saturday: 10:00am; **Vigil Mass:** 6:30pm

CONFESSIONS:
Sunday: 09:45am - 10:50am
Monday: 6:30pm - 6:55pm
Tuesday: 08:10am - 08:30am
Thursday: 09:30am - 09:55am
Saturday: 10:30am-11:30am; &, 5:45pm - 6:20pm

SACRAMENT OF BAPTISM

We welcome into the family of the Church:
Sonny Lynch; Tommy-Liam Johnstone;
Leo Gallagher; Clodagh Doherty;
Hunter McMonagle and Raya Canning.

ANNIVERSARIES

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
Paddy Moore; Margaret McKinney;
Kathleen Harkin; Jim Harkin;
Colm Geary; Jackie McGuinness
and Ruby McGuinness.

RETIRED PRIEST'S COLLECTION

Will be taken up at all Masses this weekend, 12/13 September.
There is a special envelope in your collection envelope box.

COLLECTION

Last Sunday's Collection amounted to £2,990.
Thank you for your generosity.

ANNIVERSARY AND MONTH'S MIND MASSES

To book a Mass for an anniversary or month's mind please contact the parish office by telephone on 02871 351718 or by email at steelstown@derrydiocese.org.

The daytime Masses will only be offered for one intention but the evening Masses, Monday at 7pm and Saturday 6.30pm, can be offered for more than one intention.

VOCATIONS

Anyone interested in serving the diocese of Derry as a priest should contact their local priest(s) and/or the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP, Bellaghy, at pgoh2111@gmail.com.

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 13th September 2026

Twenty-Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time

HOW OFTEN TO FORGIVE

In our Gospel this weekend St Matthew continues to deal with relations between Christians, focusing on the need for forgiveness. Peter asks Jesus how often he should forgive his brother and then answers the question by suggesting seven times.

Just as in days of old as in our own time and the time of Jesus Christ there was no limit to hatred, evil and vengeance, likewise in the eyes of Jesus there is no limit to mercy and forgiveness.

The parable of the unforgiving official is told to underline the need for forgiveness. When the accounts are audited there is a huge deficiency. The sum is deliberately extravagant to heighten the contrast with the small amount owed to the official.

Despite the King cancelling the official's debt he learns nothing. The official seems to forget that he has had his debt cancelled. Forgetfulness of our own sins and human weakness can lead us to lack of compassion. Through forgetfulness of God's compassion, we can end up becoming cruel to each other.

In the first reading we have good advice which underlines the futility of vengeance and anger. **"If a man nurses anger against another, can he demand compassion from the Lord? Showing no pity for a man like himself, can he then plead for his own sins?"** Nursing anger and not forgiving disables us and renders us defenseless when we look for forgiveness for our own sins.

Remember - "To err is human; to forgive is, divine". Alexander Pope

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION - The Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. We invite people to attend an Information Meeting on Wednesday 30th September at 8pm in the Drummond Hotel, 2 Main Street Ballykelly.

TRIDUUM OF MASSES AND PRAYERS for Bishop Michael Router

As the Diocese prepares to celebrate the joyous occasion of the Installation of Bishop Michael Router as Bishop of Derry, we are invited to participate in a time of prayer and a Triduum of Masses on Friday 18th, Saturday 19th and Sunday 20th of this month.

Prayer - God of holiness, we give you thanks for this diocese, the church that is the Diocese of Derry. We recall with thanks all who handed on the gift of faith in past generations, in difficult and in troubled times down to the present day. We look forward with hope as we walk together in faith with our new Bishop. We pray that we may become more faithful disciples of Jesus and joyful witnesses to his Gospel for the many generations who will follow us in the parishes of our diocese.

Baptisms – We welcome into God’s family: Zack Doherty, Garrymore Place, Strathfoyle, Fiachra Quinn, Moyglass Place.

Anniversaries – Danny McGeady, Lily Gillespie, Sean McElholm, John O’Kane, John Diver, Michael Harkin, Elizabeth Harkin, Adrian Sharkey, Annette Mortimor, Joseph Doherty, Philomena Martin, Anna McGarvey, Michael North, Mickey McLaughlin, Sean Moore, Tony Dunne, William O’Donnell, Mark O’Donnell, Billy Duddy.

Vocations – In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who "...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy." (Responsorial Psalm).

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb’s Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb’s Church (Parish Hall)

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,285.00 Strathfoyle: £555.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

This week’s collection is the Priest’s Stipend Collection

Coffee Morning – The staff of Enagh Seniors group are holding a coffee morning on Tuesday 15th September from 10.30 – 12.30 in Strathfoyle Library. In aid of McMillan Cancer.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments.

“He who sings, prays twice.” (St Augustine) – St Columb’s Church resumed last weekend. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Markus or any choir members.

'Trench Rd Folk Group are returning for practise on Wednesday 16th January in Malvern Terrace Parish Hall at 7pm. New and returning singers are welcome. Ages P7 up to and including adults.'

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Organ Donation Week: 21-27 September 2026 - Organ Donation Week is nearly here! Support us and help us share the message of the Gift of Life. Running from Monday 21 – Sunday 27 September. One person can save up to nine lives as an organ donor, and even more if they also donate tissue. Support Organ Donation Week by confirming your decision on the NHS Organ Donor Register at www.organdonationni.info/register-now or call 0300 123 23 23.
